

Holiday and Port Closure Operational Continuity SOP

AfaqRoute Logistics Services Co. (ARLS) | Saudi Arabia Operations

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Purpose

To manage predictable and unexpected closures without treating every closure as a carrier or service-failure event.

Scope

Applies to public holidays, announced terminal closures, border operating-hour changes, severe weather shutdowns and similar access constraints.

1. Planned closure process

- Record closure dates/hours and the source of the operational notice.
- Identify shipments whose planned milestones fall within the closure window.
- Adjust pickup, linehaul, clearance or delivery planning before dispatch where practical.
- Do not escalate as carrier failure when the transport plan already accounts for the closure.

2. Unplanned closure response

Impact	Response
<4 hours and no SLA impact	Monitor and update ETA internally.
4-12 hours or SLA at risk	Operations owner creates recovery plan.
Customer commitment affected	Notify Account Owner and customer.
High-value/perishable/secure cargo	Duty Manager review.
Closure >24 hours	Business Continuity review and alternate-route assessment.

3. Knowledge-base guidance

- When a confirmed closure explains the delay and no immediate action is possible, the recommended action may be 'monitor / no action'.
- The response should still identify the affected shipment, confirmed closure, next review time and SLA impact.
- Use official notices or documented carrier/terminal communications as evidence where available.

Records and audit trail

All material actions, timestamps, approvals, customer notifications and supporting evidence must be recorded against the shipment or incident reference in the transport management system.

Control note

This internal document does not replace Saudi laws, customs instructions, carrier terms, customer contracts or directions issued by competent authorities.